

Sysmon

What is Sysmon

Sysmon logs:

- Process creation (who ran what)
- Network connections (very important for attacks)
- File changes
- Registry activity

👉 These logs go into **Event Viewer** → **Applications and Services Logs** → **Microsoft** → **Windows** → **Sysmon**

PART # 1

STEP 1: Download Sysmon

1. Go to Microsoft official Sysinternals page
2. Download **Sysmon.zip**

👉 Or search: "Sysmon Sysinternals download"

1. Extract the ZIP file

You'll get:

- `Sysmon.exe`
 - `Sysmon64.exe`
-

STEP 2: Move Files (Important)

1. Create folder:

```
C:\Sysmon
```

1. Copy:

- `Sysmon64.exe` → into `C:\Sysmon`

STEP 3: Download Configuration File (VERY IMPORTANT)

⚠ Sysmon without config = almost useless

Use a professional config like:

👉 SwiftOnSecurity config

Search:

"sysmonconfig-export.xml GitHub"

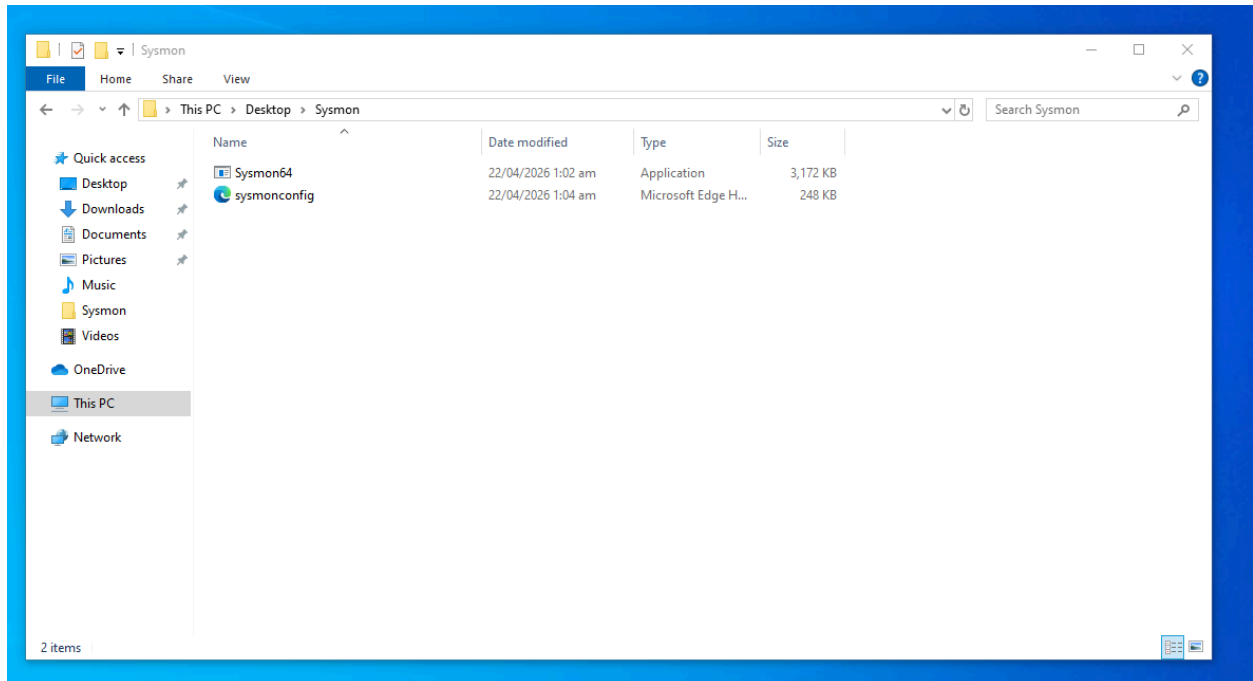
Download the `.xml` file

Rename it to:

```
sysmonconfig.xml
```

Place it in:

```
C:\Sysmon
```



STEP 4: Install Sysmon

1. Open **Command Prompt as Administrator**
2. Run:

```
cd C:\Sysmon
```

Then:

```
sysmon64.exe -accepteula -i sysmonconfig.xml
```

STEP 5: Verify Installation

You should see:

👉 "Sysmon installed successfully"

Now check logs:

1. Press **Win + R**

2. Type:

```
eventvwr.msc
```

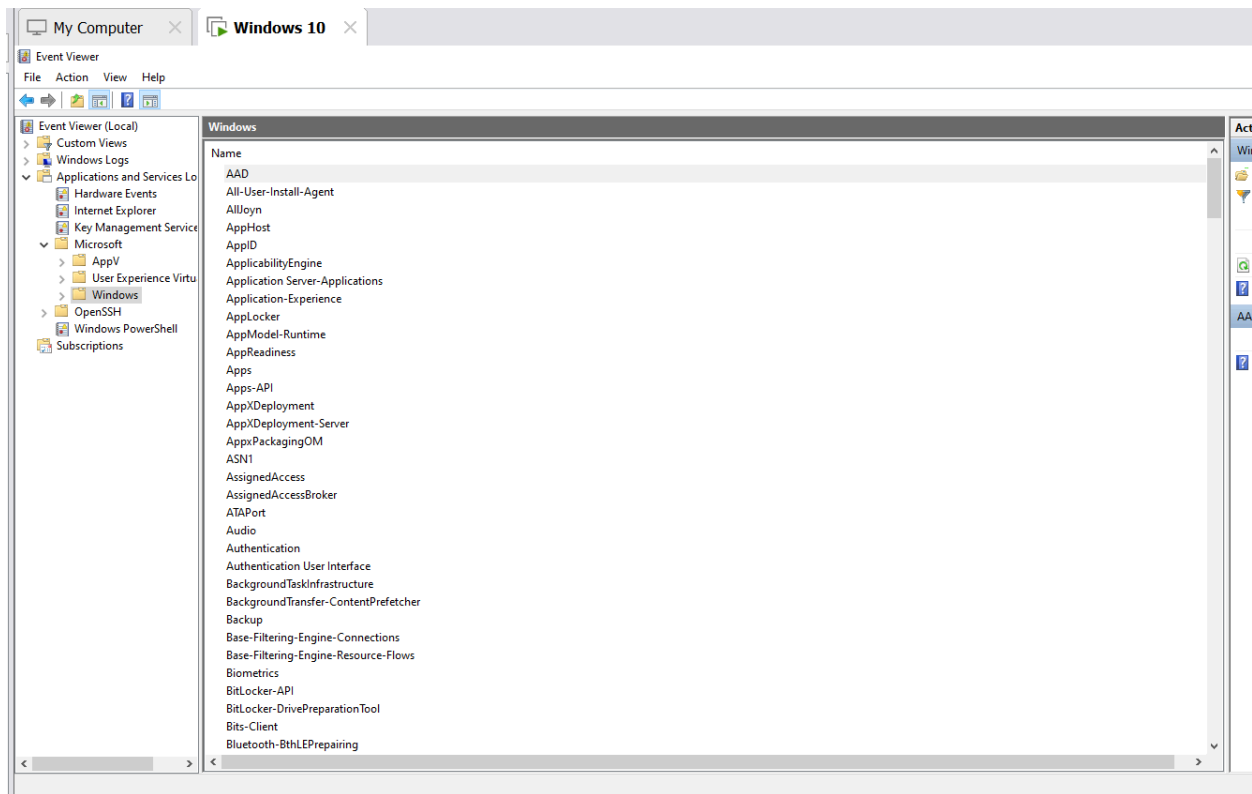
1. Go to:

👉 Applications and Services Logs

→ Microsoft

→ Windows

→ **Sysmon** → **Operational**



STEP 6: Test It (VERY IMPORTANT)

Run something simple:

```
notepad.exe
```

Then check Sysmon logs:

👉 You should see **Event ID 1 (Process Create)**

STEP 7: Auto Start Check

Sysmon runs as a service:

1. Open:

```
services.msc
```

1. Find:

👉 **Sysmon64**

Status should be:

- ✓ Running
 - ✓ Automatic
-

PART # 2: Connect Sysmon Logs to Wazuh

Since you are using Wazuh:

👉 Sysmon logs will be forwarded via Wazuh agent

This is where real SOC detection starts

STEP 1: Edit Wazuh Agent Config

On Windows:

```
C:\Program Files (x86)\ossec-agent\ossec.conf
```

Open with **Notepad (Run as Admin)**

METHOD 2: Use Windows PowerShell (Fast Way)

1. Open PowerShell as Administrator
2. Run:

```
notepad"C:\Program Files (x86)\ossec-agent\ossec.conf"
```

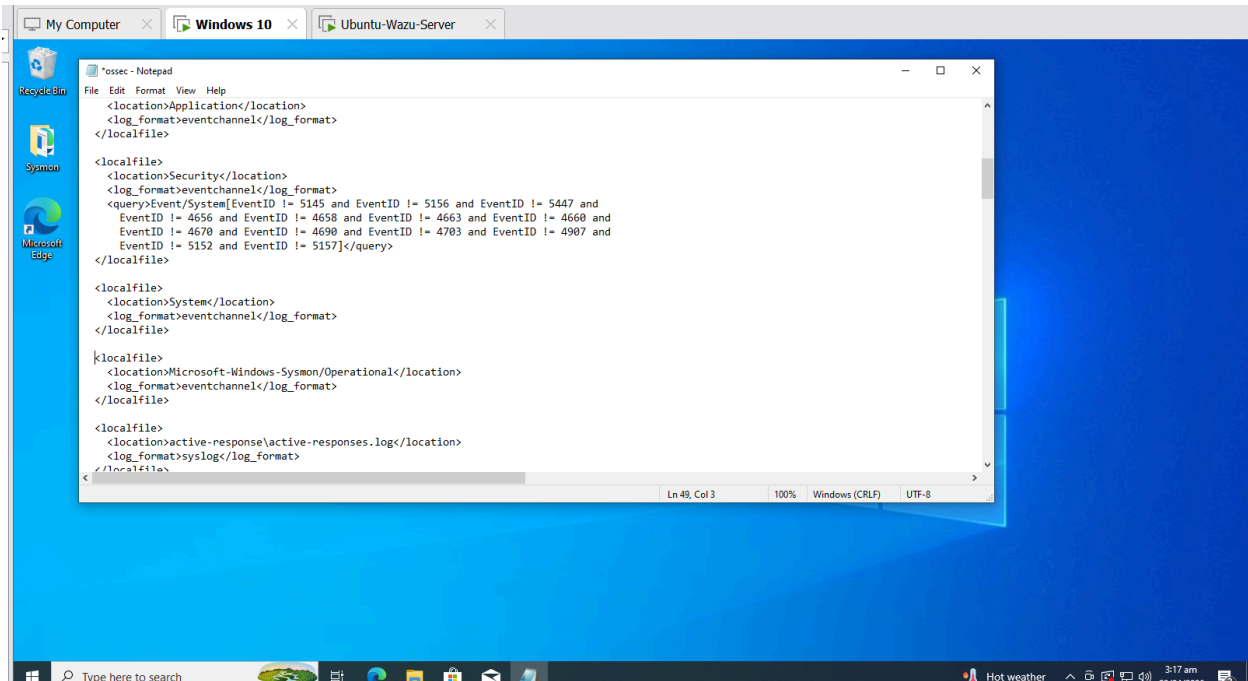
STEP 2: Add Sysmon Log Monitoring

Find:

```
<localfile>
```

Add this block:

```
<localfile>  
  <location>Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon/Operational</location>  
  <log_format>eventchannel</log_format>  
</localfile>
```



STEP 3: Save File

Save `ossec.conf`

STEP 4: Restart Wazuh Agent

```
net stop wazuh
net start wazuh
```

PART 3: TEST (SOC-Level Validation)

Now test like a real analyst:

On Windows:

Run:

```
notepad.exe
```

On Wazuh Dashboard:

Go to:

👉 Security Events / Discover

Search:

sysmon

OR

event.id:1

👉 You should see:

✓ Process creation logs

✓ Command execution

✓ User activity

The screenshot shows the Wazuh Dashboard interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Threat Hunting' and 'Windows_Client'. A search bar at the top right contains the text 'sysmon'. Below the search bar, a bar chart shows the distribution of events over time. The main table displays 193 hits for the search query. The table columns are: timestamp, agent.name, rule.description, rule.level, and rule.id. The data shows multiple instances of 'Executable dropped in Windows root folder' and 'Process loaded taskchd.dll module. May be used to create delayed malware execution'.

timestamp	agent.name	rule.description	rule.level	rule.id
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.578	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.582	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.547	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.531	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.515	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.486	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.469	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.454	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:44.438	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:38.326	Windows_Client	Process loaded taskchd.dll module. May be used to create delayed malware execution	4	92154
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:17.996	Windows_Client	Process loaded taskchd.dll module. May be used to create delayed malware execution	4	92154
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:17.137	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:17.123	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:17.106	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217
Apr 22, 2026 @ 15:40:17.091	Windows_Client	Executable dropped in Windows root folder	6	92217

What You Just Achieved

You now have:

- ✓ Windows endpoint monitoring
- ✓ Sysmon deep logging
- ✓ Centralized detection via Wazuh